

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Al Baster

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS

Al Baster

Sculptor & Public-Art Star

Al considers a pedestal a sculpture that has given up on itself. Al makes monumental sculpture in stone, steel, and whatever else can require a crane.

- Creative rival of **Frank Lloyd Wrong** after an argument about the entrance installation.
- Friendly competitor of **Vincent Van Faux**.

ACTING TIPS

Big presence, playful arrogance, generous when admired, combative when minimized.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Al Baster. I made the entrance sculpture. I would appreciate your admiration in a tone that suggests prompt payment.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

INTRODUCTIONS

Al Baster

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant planned to replace your commissioned entrance sculpture with a cheaper replica after the opening and dispute your final payment.

Your other secret

You built one internal support differently from the approved plan because the fabricator missed a deadline.

Conversations to start

- Ask Frank Lloyd Wrong whether the entrance display still includes your original sculpture.
- Ask Vincent Van Faux how he handles patrons who try to replace an artist's work.

If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else. Your printed account may conceal another scandal, even if you are innocent. Stick to it during the hearings; save corrections for Coming Clean.

Memorize your animal and return the slip. When the host announces the selected animal, use IF MURDERER if it matches yours; otherwise use IF INNOCENT. Never read an IF heading aloud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

HUNT FOR CLUES

Al Baster

The museum has misplaced its paperwork. Naturally.

Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the house. These three hints lead to three different hiding places. Leave the furniture and household objects where they are. Bring an envelope to the Evidence Table; read and share the discovery inside.

- 1** *Find the frame that always contains a portrait of you; check its top.*
- 2** *A wall-hung painting has a backstage area. That is where to investigate.*
- 3** *A blue cushion has been acting as a very quiet accomplice. Check its reverse.*

Already found? Read that discovery at the Evidence Table, then try another hint. Ask for help reaching a hiding place; nobody needs to climb. You may investigate together.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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ACT I: MOTIVE

Al Baster

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant's financial plans threaten to take from you?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did Grant demand over a sale or purchase?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What unwelcome research did Grant want suppressed?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide, and why?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute demand put your work at risk?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What dispute made you want Grant's announcement stopped?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past decision was Grant threatening to expose?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant's decisions threaten your livelihood or work?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

ACT I: MOTIVE

Al Baster

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

EVERYONE / READ ALOUD

My invoice was quite specific. Grant wanted to replace my commissioned entrance sculpture with a cheaper replica after opening night and dispute my final payment. He would still have the photographs of my work at his gala. I would have the invoice and an empty plinth.

You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

ACT II: OPPORTUNITY

Al Baster

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

Where were you before the toast, and why?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What were you checking in the exhibition, and when?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What occupied you before Grant's private toast?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

Where did your work take you before the toast?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What were you examining before the unveiling, and when?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did you observe while the toast was prepared?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute work were you doing, and where?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

Where did you go before the toast, and why?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What drew you to the exhibition before the toast?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What were you arranging before Grant drank?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

ACT II: OPPORTUNITY

Al Baster

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Earlier, about 6:34 by my watch, I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to check the velvet shelf under the object. At the toast I was outside the alcove in the East Gallery. My restricted-area photograph was not for sale. My invoice was quite specific.

IF MURDERER

I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to test the velvet-covered shelf supporting the bowl. That was about 6:46; I checked my watch. A sculptor notices what everyone else assumes will hold. I had approached his salon about the restricted-area photograph.

You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

ACT III: METHOD

Al Baster

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did you handle or conceal during setup?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What materials or records passed through your hands?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did you borrow, conceal or change tonight?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

What did you alter that could look suspicious?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What did you discover or conceal in your work?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

Which objects or records need your explanation?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What changed during setup, and what did you do?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What might someone misinterpret about your preparations?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What part of your past or preparation needs explaining?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What passed through your hands that matters tonight?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

ACT III: METHOD

Al Baster

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

EVERYONE / READ ALOUD

I changed an internal sculpture support because the fabricator missed the deadline. It differs from the approved plan. Grant wanted photographs of my work without paying for it. I wanted payment and a standing sculpture. An object that needs a structural inspection is not evidence that its maker has poisoned the patron.

Evidence Table / discovery index

- | | |
|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| 1. Gift agreement | 9. Education reallocation |
| 2. Shipping manifest / 1988 | 10. Donor Salon camera |
| 3. A warning left behind | 11. Donation entry / 1989 |
| 4. GRANT'S NIGHT OF GLORY | 12. Closing reveal / concept |
| 5. Treatment finding | 13. Display proposal / superseded |
| 6. Donor agreement / margin copy | 14. Clock inspection slip |
| 7. Auction result | 15. Cancelled programme cue |
| 8. Vincent Van Faux | 16. Grant Larceny's toast |



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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ACCUSATIONS

Al Baster

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Fold this loose page writing inward and give only the ballot to the host. Keep your packet for Coming Clean. Votes lock when all ballots are collected.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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COMING CLEAN

Al Baster

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. If none confesses, the host calls the selected animal to stand. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I changed an internal sculpture support from the approved plan. My claim to check the velvet shelf under the object was invented. I borrowed that detail from the abandoned cabinet proposal to conceal my preparations. At the toast I really was outside the alcove in the East Gallery, as I told you. That false errand covered my other misconduct; I did not poison Grant Larceny.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

My invoice was quite specific. Grant wanted to replace my commissioned entrance sculpture with a cheaper replica after opening night and dispute my final payment. He would still have the photographs of my work at his gala. I would have the invoice and an empty plinth. I stole the toxin and wiped it inside Grant's empty coupe with museum linen before the cordial was poured. I invented a late alcove visit from the old programme and enclosed-cabinet drawing. I had missed both the early closure and the open-cradle installation. Others lied about their times to hide scandals; my claimed work never happened at all. I was at Grant's glass instead. I acted alone. I poisoned Grant Larceny.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.